

TRAINING OF SHIS

Haj 2026-

Health and Medical care of Indian pilgrims How to handle Medical Emergency Situation in KSA

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NUTSHELL

- **INTRODUCTION**
- **HEALTH RISKS AND PREVENTION.**
- **UNDERSTANDING & ATTENDING MEDICAL EMERGENCIES.**
- **CARDIOPULMONARY RESUSCITATION**
- **EMERGENCY CONTACT DETAILS.**
- **TAKE HOME MESSAGE**

INTRODUCTION

- The Holy Haj Pilgrimage is a large-scale mass gathering where over 30 lakh of people from around the world visit the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia
- From India alone, about 1.75 lakh pilgrims will be performing Haj this year.
- Though the overall healthcare needs of the pilgrims are catered to by the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, each country also caters to the health needs of its pilgrims.

HEALTH RISKS

- Pilgrims face health risks due to severe weather conditions(extreme heat), outdoor rituals, and large gatherings.
- These risks encompass both the potential for **communicable diseases** and the worsening of **non-communicable illnesses**.
- Recognizing these health concerns and implementing effective preventive strategies is essential.

HEALTH RISKS

Potential Health Risks include

- Heat related illness
- Respiratory illness
- Gastrointestinal illness
- Skin problems
- Exacerbation of underlying chronic diseases.

Exposure to abnormal or prolonged amounts of heat without adequate fluid intake can cause various types of heat related illness

- Dehydration
- Heat cramps
- Heat exhaustion
- Heat stroke



HEAT RELATED ILLNESS

- **Tawaf**, especially during midday hours.
- **Al-Masaa**, especially when there is severe overcrowding and high temperature.
- **Arafat** during midday hours
- **Mina, particularly at the locations of sacrificing animals and throwing pebbles at the pillars**, due to the long distances and crowding during the ritual of stoning the pillars.

HEAT RELATED ILLNESS

DEHYDRATION

Excessive sweating and lack of proper fluid intake can lead to dehydration. Presents as

- Dry mouth
- **Excessive thirst**
- Dark urine
- Dizziness
- Fatigue



HEAT CRAMPS	HEAT EXHAUSTION	HEAT STROKE
Mildest form	It is a condition where the body loses fluids and electrolytes due to excessive sweating and inadequate intake of water and fluids. More severe than heat cramps	Most severe form and life threatening
• Occur after exertion and sweating in high Temp. • Painful muscle cramps and spasms, usually in legs and abdomen • Flushed, moist skin • Mild fever(+/-)	Heavy sweating • Weakness or tiredness • Fast, weak pulse • Muscle cramps • Dizziness • Nausea or vomiting • Headache • Fainting • Fever over 100°F • Anxiety	• High body temperature (above 104°F) • Hot, dry skin (sweating may have stopped) • Rapid, strong pulse • Nausea or vomiting • Headache • Dizziness • Confusion or agitation • Loss of consciousness • Seizures

HEAT RELATED ILLNESS

PREVENTION

- Stay hydrated by drinking water/ors frequently (at least 3-4 liters per day)
- Consume water-rich foods such as fruits and vegetables
- Avoid direct sun exposure using umbrellas, hats and staying in shaded areas
- Wear light-colored, loose fitting cotton clothing
- Take regular breaks
- Perform rituals at night if possible
- Perform rituals in proxy when allowed
- Use wet towels or cooling packs on the neck and head
- Avoid caffeinated drinks and sodas, as they increase dehydration

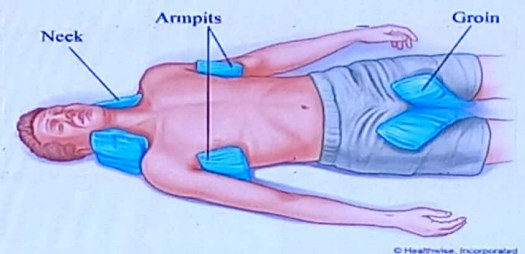
HEAT RELATED ILLNESS

SEEK MEDICAL CARE

- If symptoms of heat stroke are suspected
- Move the person to a cooler environment
- Reduce body temperature with ice packs or a cool bath
- Give ORS or water (Do not give fluids if the person is unconscious)
- Call medical services immediately

—COOL FIRST, TRANSPORT SECOND

- Begin CPR if the person loses consciousness and shows no signs of circulation





RESPIRATORY ILLNESS

INFLUENZA (FLU)

Due to close contact with thousands of people, flu and flu like illness can spread rapidly.

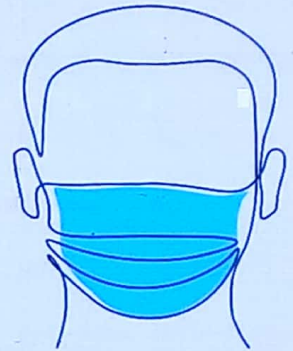
Patients with flu present with typical symptoms of

- Fever
- Cough, sore throat
- Body ache
- Breathing difficulties in severe cases(pneumonia)

RESPIRATORY ILLNESS

PREVENTION

- Avoid close contact with people who show symptoms of respiratory illness
- Wear a face mask especially in crowded areas
- Wash hands frequently with soap and water or use hand sanitizer
- Cover the nose and mouth with a tissue when coughing or sneezing and discard the tissue in the trash bin.
- Seek medical help if symptoms persist and associated with significant respiratory distress



GASTROINTESTINAL ILLNESS

FOOD POISONING

Consumption of contaminated food or water can cause bacterial infections. Individuals start experiencing

- Nausea
- Vomiting
- Diarrhea
- Stomach cramps
- Fever
- F/S/O Dehydration



GASTROINTESTINAL ILLNESS

PREVENTION

Make sure to wash vegetables and fruits well.

Food should be thoroughly cooked and kept in the refrigerator.

Do not leave food at room temperature for more than 2 hours.

Do not eat food that is uncovered, stored outside the refrigerator

Properly wash hands before and after eating food

Eat fresh food whenever possible

Hand Washing



Wet hands with water.



Apply soap.



Rub hands palms to palms.



Rub the back of each hand with fingers interlaced.



Rub palms together with fingers interlaced.



Rub with back of fingers to the opposing palms.



Rub each thumb clasped in opposite hands.



Rub the tips of fingers.



Rub each wrist with different hands



Rinse with water.



Dry thoroughly your hands.



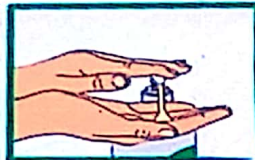
Your hands are now clean.

Source: World Health Organization

Hand Washing



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SKIN PROBLEMS

HEAT RASH (PRICKLY HEAT)

Excessive sweating and blocked sweat glands due to heat and humidity.

Symptoms:

- Red, itchy, and bumpy rash on the skin.
- Burning or prickling sensation.
- Commonly occurs on the neck, chest, back, and groin.



SKIN PROBLEMS

HEAT RASH (PRICKLY HEAT)

Prevention

- Wear loose, breathable cotton clothing.
- Stay in well-ventilated or air-conditioned areas when possible.
- Keep skin dry; use talcum powder or antifungal powders.
- Take cool showers frequently.
- Cold sponge and anti histamine is helpful

SKIN PROBLEMS

FUNGAL INFECTIONS (RING WORM)

Causes:

- Moist and warm conditions favor fungal growth.
- Walking barefoot in public areas.
- Poor hygiene and sharing towels or personal items.

Symptoms:

- Itchy, scaly, red patches (commonly in feet, groin, or underarms).
- Burning sensation and bad odor..

SKIN PROBLEMS

FUNGAL INFECTIONS

Prevention

- Keep feet and body dry, especially in skin folds.
- Change socks and undergarments daily.
- Use antifungal powders or creams regularly.
- Avoid sharing towels, socks, or personal items.
- Always wear footwear in public bathrooms and ablution areas.

SKIN PROBLEMS

CHAFING (SKIN IRRITATION DUE TO FRICTION)

Causes

- Continuous rubbing of skin against clothing or other body parts.
- Excessive sweating and poor ventilation in skin folds (thighs, armpits).

Symptoms

- Red, sore, and irritated skin.
- Burning or stinging sensation.



SKIN PROBLEMS

CHAFING (SKIN IRRITATION DUE TO FRICTION)

Prevention

- Apply petroleum jelly or anti-chafing cream before intended lengthy walks.
- Keep thighs and underarms dry; use talcum powder if needed.

SKIN PROBLEMS

SKIN BLISTERS

Small fluid-filled sacs that form on the skin due to prolonged walking, excessive heat and friction

Two Types: Pressure Blister/Burn Blister

Symptoms:

- Painful, fluid-filled blisters on the feet.
- Redness and irritation around the affected area
- Risk of infection if the blister breaks.



SKIN PROBLEMS

SKIN BLISTERS

Management:

- Do not pop the blister to prevent infection.
- Keep the area clean and dry.
- Apply antiseptic ointment and cover with a sterile bandage.
- Offload the blister area and take rest
- If infected (signs include redness, swelling, or pus), seek medical assistance at the nearest Haj medical facility.

Chronic diseases exacerbation

All the patients who are on regular medicines for illness like Hypertension, Diabetes, Asthma, Hypo-Hyperthyroid or other chronic illness, **must** take their medicines regularly and **must** ensure good control of these diseases.

DIABETES MELLITUS

- Uncontrolled blood sugar can result in to diabetes related infection Cellulitis, abcess, dibetic foot ulcers and life threatnig condition like ketoacidosis.
- Long hours of fasting, dehydration, and stress can worsen diabetes

Prevention

- Carry all necessary medications and take them on time.
- Monitor blood sugar regularly.
- Avoid excessive physical strain; rest when needed.
- Maintain a balanced diet and avoid sugary or salty foods.
- Carry sugar or glucose along with you in case of hypoglycemia

HYPERTENSION

Prevention

- Carry all necessary medications and take them on time.
- Monitor blood pressure regularly.
- Avoid excessive physical strain, take rest when needed.
- Maintain a balanced diet and avoid salty foods.

ASTHMA

Patients who are known case of Asthma needs to be evaluated before travel and have to carry their medications along with them during travel

Prevention

Avoid situations that increase the risk of respiratory infections that exacerbate Asthma

- Wear face mask and avoid crowded places
- Carry Nebulisers along
- Train regarding how to use nebuliser in a proper way
- Deep Breathing exercises

FALLS & FRACTURES

Falls and fractures common Haj Pilgrimage

Prevention

- –Walk carefully, especially in crowded places
- Use wheel chair if you have mobility issues
- Wear sturdy, non-slip footwear



FALLS & FRACTURES

- Pilgrims should mind their steps especially in crowds and slippery surfaces to avoid fall.
- Learn proper use of WC, Improper use may result into **injury** and **hygiene compromise**
- Do not venture to take Boshra of **Hazre Ashwad** or **Multazim** when it is very crowded. We have seen cases of ribs and other bone fractures
- Beaware of traffic rules. RTA and deaths are not uncommon during Haj

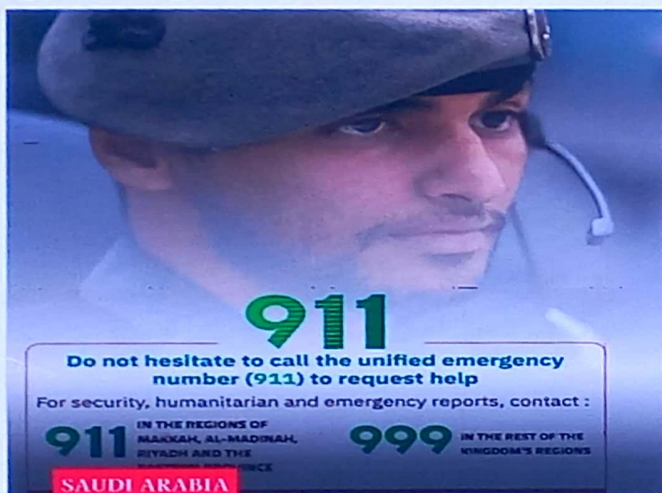
Orthopaedic and Musculoskeletal disease

- Fractures (Colle's fracture)
 - Shoulder dislocations and chest trauma (due to blunt trauma during mass gatherings)
 - Myalgias
 - low back pain
 - Sciatica
 - Crush injuries and metatarsal fractures
 - Due to overstepping and wheelchair-related injuries.
- due to stress, exertion, dehydration and old age

Seek Medical Help if you have persistent

- Fever
- Cough/Cold
- Excessive Vomiting
- Severe Diarrhoea
- Abdominal Pain
- Chest pain and discomfort
- Excess fatigue
- Fainting episodes
- Sudden visual acuity changes etc.

EMERGENCY CONTACT DETAILS AT KSA



UNIFIED
EMERGENCY
NUMBER 911

EMERGENCY CONTACT DETAILS

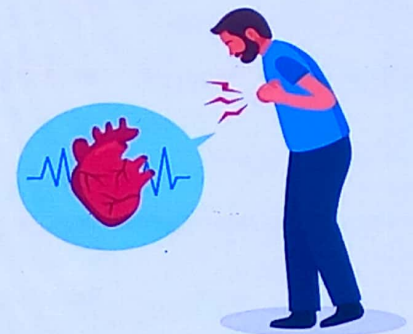
- We have Dedicated SAUDI Number for AMBULANCE COMMAND CENTRE at Holy Mecca and Madinah.

CARDIOPULMONARY RESUSCITATION

WHAT IS CPR?

CARDIO PULMONARY RESUSCITATION

- – Lifesaving technique used when heartbeat or breathing stops
- Helps maintain blood flow to the brain and vital organs
- Increases survival chances before medical help arrives
- Used in cases of cardiac arrest, drowning, choking, etc.



Few points for ladies

Menses

- Awareness regarding menstrual hygiene
- Carry enough sanitary pads, menstrual caps especially in Mina, Arafat, Muzthalifa
- There are medicines to **delay Menses**, better carry those medicines after gynac consultation
- They should be started well before for good outcome

Dos and donts for haj pilgrims

DO'S

- Wear light colour, loose, cotton cloths.
- Keep cheking BP, Blood Sugar and SPO2 if you are prone for fluctuation
- Practice frequent hand hygiene
- Delegate haj rituals to some others which are allowed, if your not fit (except Arafat)
- Use electric wheelchair provided at harm (on payment) if you need it

Dos and donts for haj pilgrims

DONT'S

- Avoid direct sun exposure
- Avoid eating unhealthy, oily and spicy meals
- Avoid crowd whenever possible
- Avoid Tawaf/Umra in mid day(specially close tp Haj)
- Avoid Halq at Non-Licensed barber
- Do not engage in any activity which violates law of kingdom
- Do not ignore the traffic rules in KSA(left hand drive)
- Do not ignore your health

TAKE HOME MESSAGE

Prioritize Health & Hygiene: Maintain cleanliness, proper food safety, and hydration throughout the pilgrimage.

Prevent Heat-Related Illnesses: Stay hydrated, avoid prolonged sun exposure, and wear loose, light-colored clothing.

Protect Against Infections: Use masks in crowded places, practice hand hygiene, and get recommended vaccinations before travel

TAKE HOME MESSAGE

Be Prepared for Chronic Conditions: Carry necessary medications, monitor health conditions, and seek medical help when needed.

Know First Aid & Emergency Response: Learn CPR, recognize medical emergencies, and use available healthcare facilities effectively.

Utilize Medical Facilities: Familiarize yourself with available healthcare centers and emergency services in Haj locations.

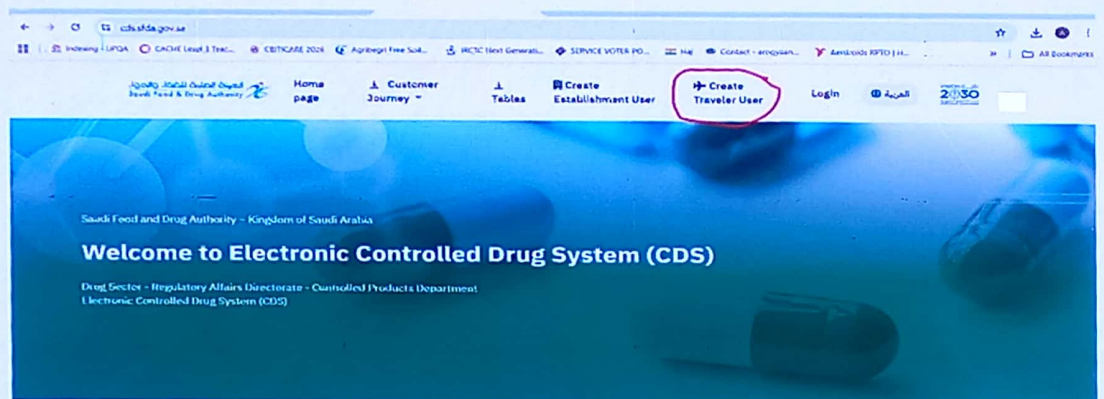
- Effective November 1, 2025, Saudi Arabia will require advance registration for certain prescription drugs for all travelers arriving to and departing from the Kingdom.*
- This includes, but is not limited to, travellers with prescription for pain, anxiety, and Insomnia medication.

SL.NO	CHEMICAL NAME	TRADE NAME	PURPOSE
1	ALPRAZOLAM	ALPRAX, RESTYL -0.5 MG, 1 MG	INSOMNIA & घबराहट
2	CLONAZEPAM	LONAZEP, PETRIL-0.25 MG, 0.5 MG	INSOMNIA- नींद की गोली
3	LORAZEPAM	LARPOSE- 1MG, 2MG	INSOMNIA- नींद की गोली
4	DIAZEPAM	VALIUM -10 MG	नींद की गोली
5	ZOLPIDEM	ZOLFRESH, NITREST – 10 MG	नींद की गोली
6	CODEINE -COUGH SYRUP	COREX Cough Syrup,	सूखी खांसी के सिरप
7	PREGABALIN	PREGALIN, LYRICA 75 MG.	DIABETIC NEUROPATHY-नसों में खराबी

Step 1: Go to - <https://cds.sfda.gov.sa>.

Step 2. Click – Create Traveller User.

Fill in the details..



cds.sfda.gov.sa/home/index

Indexing - UFGA CACHE Level 3 Feas... CRITICARE 2026 Agribegri Free Soil... IBCTC Nest Generati... SERVICE VOTER PO... Haj Contact - arogyaan... Androids RPTO | H... All Bookmarks

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2030

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Traveler Journey English

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Saudi Food and Drug Authority – Kingdom of Saudi Arabia

Welcome to Electronic Controlled Drug System (CDS)

Drug Sector - Regulatory Affairs Directorate - Controlled Products Department
Electronic Controlled Drug System (CDS)

